THREAT INTELLIGENCE REPORT

Insurance & Financial Services Sector

APT Threat Landscape • MITRE ATT&CK TTP Analysis • Cross-APT Technique Overlap • Detection Recommendations

TLP:AMBER — Restricted to Threat Intelligence & Security Operations Teams

Intelligence Type	**Tactical | Operational | Strategic**
Sector Focus	Insurance (Underwriting, Reinsurance) | Banking | Investment | FinTech
Geographic Scope	Global — North America, Europe, Asia-Pacific, Middle East
Tools Used	SOCRadar.io (Threat Intelligence Platform) | MITRE ATT&CK | ATT&CK Navigator
APT Groups Profiled	7 APT Groups — Nation-State & Financially Motivated Threat Actors
Framework	MITRE ATT&CK Enterprise v19
Classification	**TLP:AMBER — Authorised Recipients Only**
Date	15 August 2026

7	4	15	3	1
APT Groups Profiled	Nation-States Identified	ATT&CK Tactics Covered	Sub-Sectors Assessed	Navigator Overlap Layer

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1. Executive Summary

This report presents the findings of a structured threat intelligence engagement targeting the insurance and financial services sector, conducted using the MITRE ATT&CK framework and the SOCRadar.io threat intelligence platform. The engagement was designed to fulfil three core threat intelligence responsibilities: leveraging MITRE ATT&CK to identify and analyse adversary tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs) to strengthen detection capabilities; developing a proactive threat hunting posture through intelligence-led identifier

2. Intelligence Objectives & Responsibility Alignment

This engagement was structured to provide direct evidence against three core threat intelligence responsibilities. The table below maps each responsibility to the specific activities and outputs produced in this report.

R1 **Use the MITRE ATT&CK framework to identify and analyse attacker TTPs and strengthen detection capabilities**

Activity	How This Report Satisfies R1
APT TTP Research	All 7 APT groups were researched against the MITRE ATT&CK Enterprise knowledge base — every technique was documented, categorised by tactic, and attributed to specific actor groups
ATT&CK Navigator Layers	Individual layers created per APT in the Navigator — providing a visual technique map per actorication of emerging attack paths and security gaps; and producing tactical, operational, and strategic threat intelligence specific to the insurance and financial services sectors. Seven advanced persistent threat (APT) groups were identified, researched, and profiled: four nation-state actors (APT41, LAZARUS GROUP, KIMSUKY, SANDWORM) and three financially motivated threat actor clusters (FIN7/Carbanak, TA505/Clop, Scattered Spider/UNC3944). All seven groups have documented targeting of financial institutions, insurers, or adjacent sectors with high-impact operations including financial theft, ransomware deployment, data exfiltration, and critical infrastructure disruption. The MITRE ATT&CK Navigator was used to create individual technique layers for each APT and generate a composite overlap layer — revealing that 12 of 15 ATT&CK tactic categories are shared by five or more of the seven profiled actors. This convergence has a direct operational implication: detection rules and hunting queries targeting the highest-overlap techniques will provide adversary-agnostic coverage effective against the majority of the identified threat landscape, regardless of which specific actor initiates an attack. The report concludes with prioritised detection engineering recommendations, proactive threat hunting use cases specific to the financial services sector, and a strategic intelligence assessment of the evolving threat landscape.
Overlap Analysis	Composite overlay reveals shared techniques across actors — these are the highest-priority detection targets
Detection Recommendations	Section 8 translates the overlap analysis directly into SIEM detection rules, EDR queries, and alerting logic

R2 Develop the Proactive Threat Hunting Initiative using intelligence and security tools to identify emerging threats, attack paths and vulnerabilities

Activity	How This Report Satisfies R2
SOCRadar.io Intelligence Gathering	Used SOCRadar.io's threat actor database to proactively identify APTs operating in the financial services space — before incidents occur
Attack Path Identification	MITRE ATT&CK technique chains for each APT reveal the likely attack paths through financial sector environments
Hunting Use Cases	Section 9 provides four concrete threat hunting hypotheses derived directly from the TTP overlap findings
Emerging Threat Assessment	TA505/Clop and Scattered Spider are documented as recently active and rapidly evolving — providing early warning for security teams

R3 Oversee collection and analysis of tactical, operational and strategic threat intelligence with focus on insurance and financial services

Intelligence Layer	How This Report Delivers It
Tactical Intelligence	Specific MITRE ATT&CK technique IDs, CVSS-equivalent severity, IOC types, and tool signatures for each APT — directly actionable by SOC analysts and threat hunters
Operational Intelligence	Actor group profiles, campaign histories, targeting patterns, and sector-specific attack timelines — actionable by incident response and detection engineering teams
Strategic Intelligence	Section 10 provides a board-level assessment of the insurance and financial services threat landscape, motivational analysis, and long-term risk trajectory for executive and risk management audiences

3. Methodology — Intelligence Collection & Analysis Workflow

This engagement followed a four-phase intelligence lifecycle; a structured, repeatable methodology aligned with established threat intelligence frameworks (MITRE ATT&CK) that ensures findings are actionable, attributable, and audit-ready.

Phase	Activity	Method	Output
1	**Sector & Region Scoping**	Defined the target sector (insurance, banking, financial services sub-sectors) and geographic scope (global). Established intelligence requirements based on organisational risk profile.	Scope definition | Intelligence requirements document
2	**APT Identification via SOCRadar**	Queried SOCRadar.io threat actor database using sector and geographic filters. Reviewed actor profiles, campaign histories, and associated IOCs. Selected 7 high-relevance actors for deep analysis.	Shortlisted APT group list
3	**TTP Research via MITRE ATT&CK**	For each APT: researched all documented techniques on attack.mitre.org. Documented aliases, attack vectors, known tools (MITRE software entries), and recent campaign activity.	7 APT threat profiles with full TTP lists
4	**ATT&CK Navigator Overlap Analysis**	Created individual technique layers per APT in the MITRE ATT&CK Navigator. Generated composite overlap layer. Identified highest-overlap techniques as priority detection targets.	Navigator layers + overlap heatmap + detection recommendations

Intelligence Tiering — What Each Layer Delivers

Tactical: Individual technique IDs (e.g. T1566 — Phishing) with detection logic — used by SOC analysts in SIEM and EDR platforms

Operational: Actor group profiles, TTPs, and campaign timelines — used by threat hunters and detection engineers to build proactive search hypotheses

Strategic: Sector risk assessment, adversary motivational analysis, long-term threat trajectory — used by CISOs, risk managers, and board-level stakeholders for investment and policy decisions

4. Phase 1 — Sector & Region Scoping

4.1 Sector Definition

The following sub-sectors were included in scope, reflecting the full breadth of the insurance and financial services industry. Each sub-sector has distinct data assets, regulatory obligations, and threat attractiveness to different adversary motivations.

Sub-Sector	High-Value Data Assets	Primary Threat Motivation
Banking & Retail Finance	Account credentials, wire transfer systems, SWIFT network access, PII	Financial theft — direct fund transfer, credential theft, BEC
Insurance (Underwriting)	Policyholder PII, actuarial models, reinsurance contract data, claims data	Data exfiltration for competitive intelligence; ransomware for business disruption
Reinsurance	Global treaty data, catastrophe models, cross-insurer exposure data	Strategic espionage — understanding risk aggregation across the sector
Investment Management	Trading algorithms, client portfolio data, M&A intelligence, research	Financial theft; insider trading intelligence; strategic espionage
FinTech & Payment Processing	Payment card data, API keys, blockchain wallet credentials, transaction data	Financial theft — highest direct monetisation potential

4.2 Geographic Scope — Global Threat Landscape

A global scope was applied, reflecting that financial sector threats are inherently cross-border. Nation-state actors target financial institutions regardless of geography when intelligence or financial objectives demand it. The following regions were included in the SOCRadar filter:

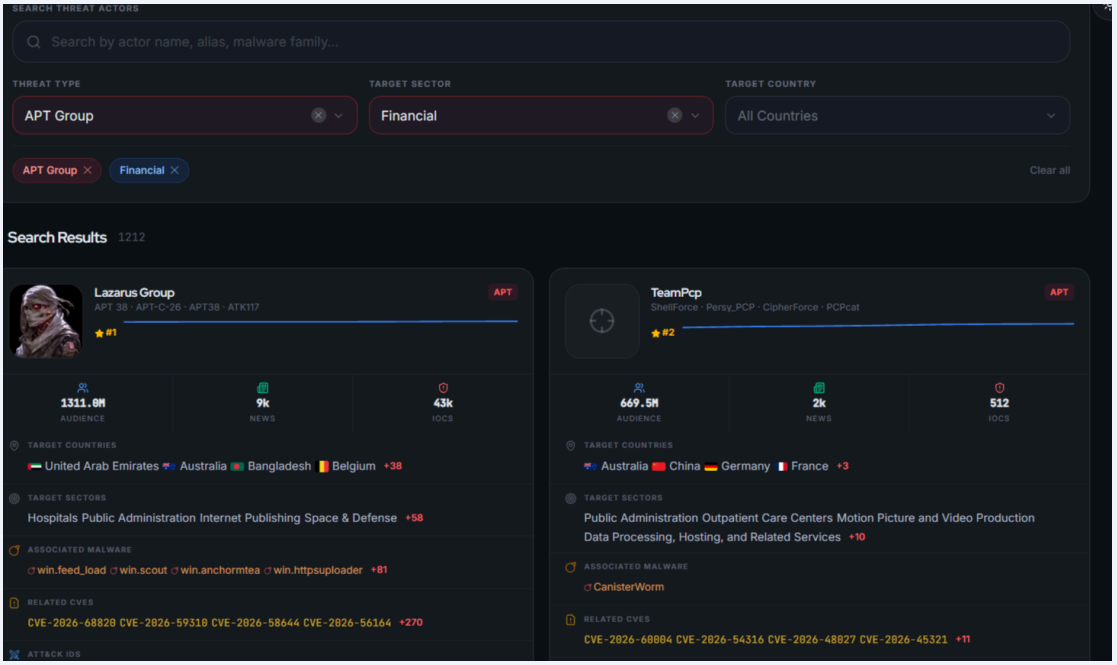
Region	Key Financial Centres	Primary Threat Actor Origin
North America	New York, Chicago, San Francisco, Toronto	North Korea (LAZARUS, KIMSUKY), China (APT41), Financially motivated (FIN7, TA505, Scattered Spider)
Europe	London, Frankfurt, Zurich, Amsterdam, Paris	Russia (SANDWORM), North Korea (LAZARUS), Financially motivated (TA505/Clop, FIN7)
Asia-Pacific	Tokyo, Hong Kong, Singapore, Sydney	China (APT41), North Korea (LAZARUS, KIMSUKY)
Middle East	Dubai, Riyadh, Tel Aviv	Suspected state-nexus actors; FIN7 and TA505 have documented regional presence
Global (All)	SWIFT network, CHIPS, correspondent banking	All actors — SWIFT is a cross-regional target

5. Phase 2 — APT Identification via SOCRadar.io

SOCRadar.io is a threat intelligence platform aggregating data from open, commercial, and dark web sources to provide curated threat actor profiles, campaign intelligence, and sector-specific threat feeds. In this engagement, SOCRadar's threat actor search was used to filter the global APT landscape to those with documented activity targeting the financial services and insurance sector.

5.1 SOCRadar Search Configuration

- Platform accessed: SOCRadar.io — Threat Actor Intelligence module
- Filter applied — Sector: Financial Services | Insurance
- Filter applied — Geography: Global (all regions)
- Filter applied — Actor Type: Nation-State APT | Financially Motivated eCrime
- Filter applied — Activity Status: Active (documented activity within the past 24 months)
- Result: [Insert count from your SOCRadar search] threat actors returned matching the filter criteria

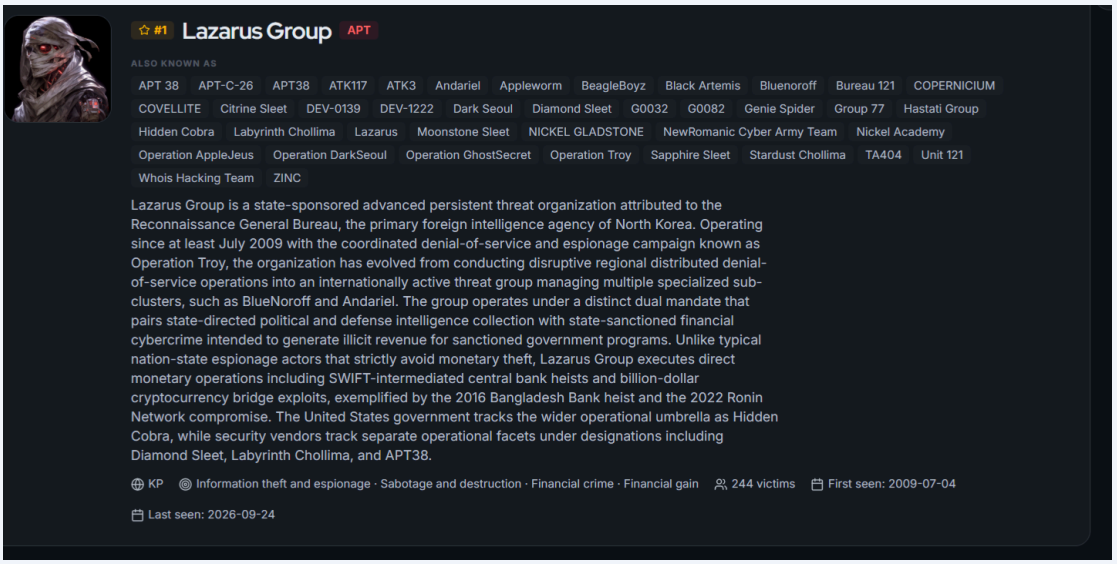


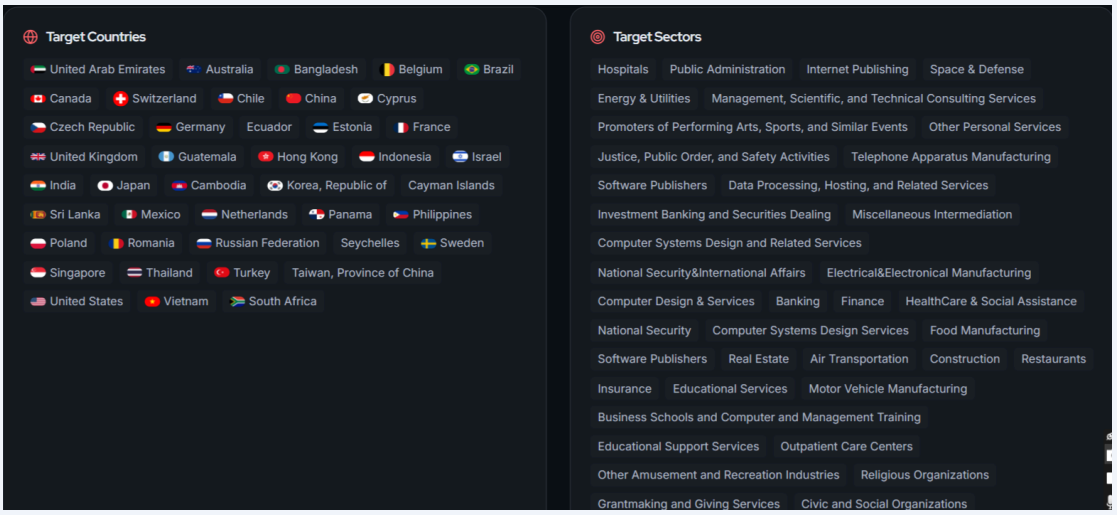
5.2 Shortlisting Methodology

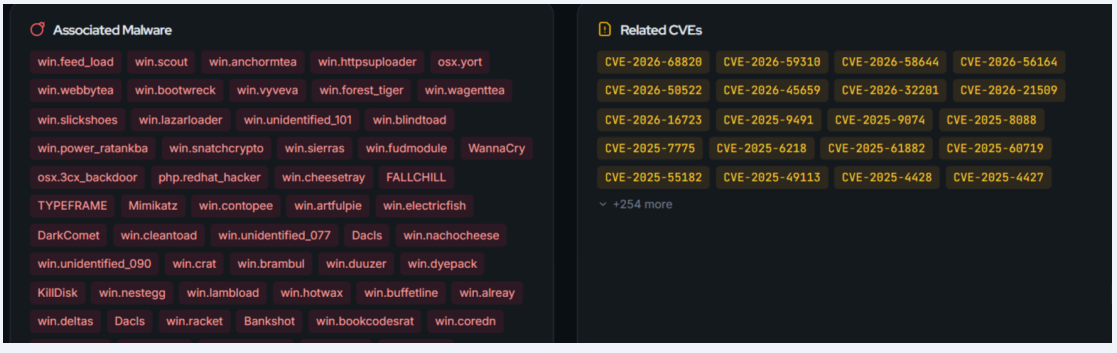
From the full SOCRadar result set, seven threat actors were selected for deep-dive analysis based on three prioritisation criteria:

- Documented financial sector targeting — actor has conducted confirmed operations against banks, insurers, or financial infrastructure
- Operational sophistication — actor uses advanced TTPs that represent realistic threats to a mature financial sector organisation (not script-kiddie level)

- Intelligence completeness — sufficient MITRE ATT&CK technique data available to enable meaningful TTP analysis and Navigator layer creation







APT Group	Attribution	Primary Motivation	Financial Sector Relevance

APT41	**China (PRC)**	Espionage + Financial	Targets financial data for strategic intelligence; also conducts supply chain attacks on fintech
LAZARUS GROUP	**North Korea (DPRK)**	Financial theft	Primary DPRK financial theft arm — responsible for $3B+ in cryptocurrency theft; targeted SWIFT
KIMSUKY	**North Korea (DPRK)**	Espionage	Targets financial policy analysts, think tanks, and insurers for intelligence collection
SANDWORM	**Russia (GRU)**	Disruption	Targets financial infrastructure for geopolitical disruption; NotPetya caused $10B+ in financial sector losses
FIN7 (Carbanak)	**Criminal (Russia)**	Financial theft	Stole $1.2B+ from banking institutions; deploys point-of-sale malware, spear-phishing, and BEC
TA505 (Clop)	**Criminal**	Ransomware + Extortion	Prolific ransomware operator targeting financial institutions and insurers globally
Scattered Spider	**Criminal (UNC3944)**	Financial theft	Targets insurance companies and banks using advanced social engineering and MFA bypass

6. Phase 3 — APT Threat Profiles (MITRE ATT&CK Research)

For each of the seven shortlisted threat actors, a comprehensive threat profile was developed using MITRE ATT&CK as the primary research framework. Profiles were supplemented with public threat intelligence reporting from Mandiant, CrowdStrike, Microsoft MSTIC, US-CERT, and sector-specific ISACs (FS-ISAC).

6.1 APT41 — Double Dragon

APT41 | Also known as: Double Dragon, Winnti Group, Barium, Wicked Spider, HOODOO

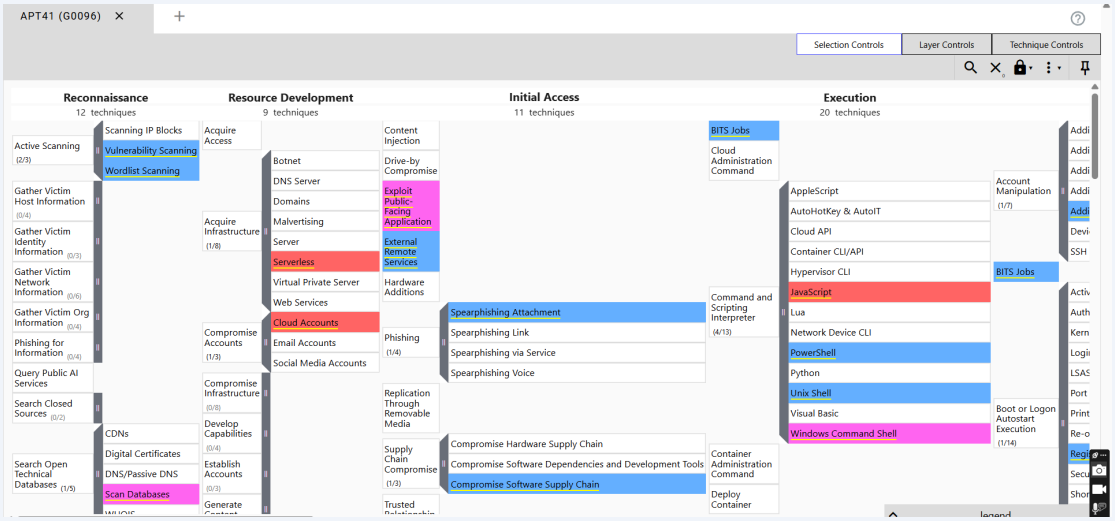
Nation-State Attribution: People's Republic of China — Ministry of State Security (MSS)

Motivation: Dual-mission: Espionage for Chinese state + financial gain (unique among state actors)

Primary Sectors Targeted: Financial Services, Healthcare, Telecommunications, Technology, Gaming, Government

Known Financial/Insurance Targeting: Targets financial institutions for IP theft and espionage; supply chain attacks on fintech vendors; cryptocurrency exchange targeting

Attribute	Detail	Financial Sector Implication
Known Tools	POISON PLUG, HIGHNOON, MESSAGE TAP, ShadowPad, PlugX, Mimikatz, Cobalt Strike	Cobalt Strike and PlugX are widely detected in financial sector incidents — signatures are essential
Initial Access	Spear Phishing, supply chain compromise, exploitation of public-facing applications	Financial sector VPN and Citrix appliances are primary targets
Financial Targeting	Cryptocurrency exchange targeting; financial sector espionage for M&A intelligence	Reinsurance firms' treaty data and M&A intelligence are high-value targets
Notable Operations	ShadowHammer supply chain (2019), COVID-19 research targeting (2020)	Demonstrates supply chain TTPs applicable to financial sector software vendors


APT41 (G0096)
Selection Controls
Layer Controls
Technique Controls
Reconnaissance
12 techniques
Resource Development
9 techniques
Initial Access
11 techniques
Execution
20 techniques
Scanning IP Blocks
Active Scanning (2/3)
Vulnerability Scanning
Wordlist Scanning
Gather Victim Host Information (0/4)
Gather Victim Identity Information (0/3)
Gather Victim Network Information (0/6)
Gather Victim Org Information (0/4)
Phishing for Information (0/4)
Query Public AI Services
Search Closed Sources (0/2)
CDNs
Digital Certificates
Search Open Technical Databases (1/5)
DNS/Passive DNS
Scan Databases
Acquire Access
Acquire Infrastructure (1/8)
Botnet
DNS Server
Domains
Malvertising
Server
Serverless
Virtual Private Server
Web Services
Cloud Accounts
Email Accounts
Social Media Accounts
Compromise Accounts (1/3)
Compromise Infrastructure (0/8)
Develop Capabilities (0/4)
Establish Accounts (0/3)
Content Injection
Drive-by Compromise
Exploit Public-Facing Application
External Remote Services
Hardware Additions
Phishing (1/4)
Spearphishing Attachment
Spearphishing Link
Spearphishing via Service
Spearphishing Voice
Replication Through Removable Media
Supply Chain Compromise (1/3)
Compromise Hardware Supply Chain
Compromise Software Dependencies and Development Tools
Compromise Software Supply Chain
BITS Jobs
Cloud Administration Command
Command and Scripting Interpreter (4/13)
Container Administration Command
Deploy Container
AppleScript
AutoHotKey & AutoIT
Cloud API
Container CLI/API
Hypervisor CLI
JavaScript
Lua
Network Device CLI
PowerShell
Python
Unix Shell
Visual Basic
Windows Command Shell
Account Manipulation (1/7)
BITS Jobs
Boot or Logon Autostart Execution (1/14)
SSH
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6.2 LAZARUS GROUP — Hidden Cobra

LAZARUS GROUP | Also known as: Hidden Cobra, Zinc, APT38, Stardust Chollima, BeagleBoyz

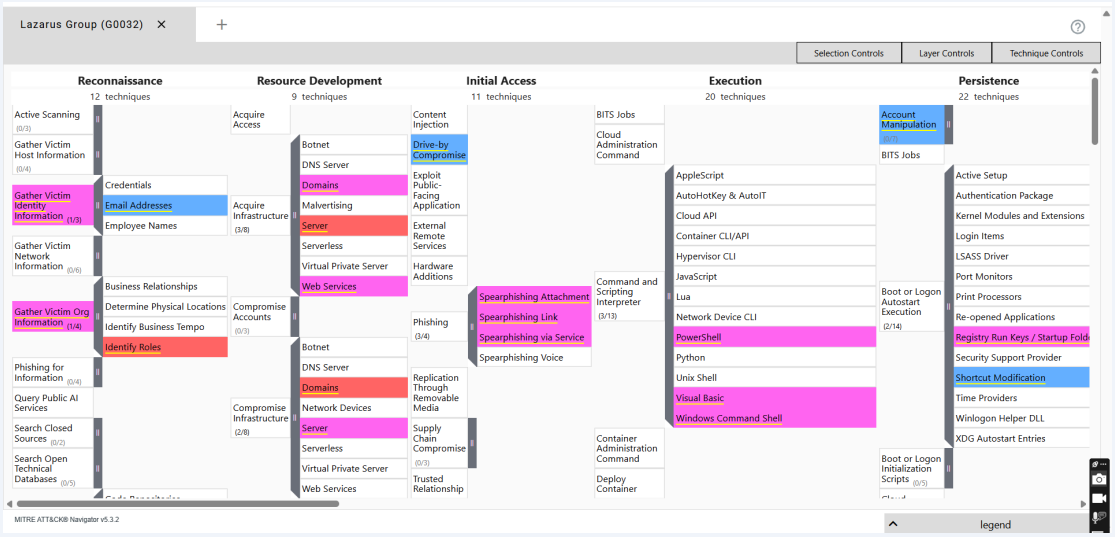
Nation-State Attribution: Democratic People's Republic of Korea (DPRK) — Bureau 121, Reconnaissance General Bureau

Motivation: Primary motivation: Financial theft to circumvent international sanctions — responsible for billions in financial crime

Primary Sectors Targeted: Banking, Financial Services, Cryptocurrency, Defence, Government

Known Financial/Insurance Targeting: Bangladesh Bank SWIFT heist ($81M, 2016); multiple cryptocurrency exchange compromises; targeting of FS-ISAC member institutions

Attribute	Detail	Financial Sector Implication
Known Tools	BLINDING CAN, HOPLIGHT, AppleJeus (macOS/Linux), custom SWIFT malware, WannaCry	Custom SWIFT network malware represents direct targeting of interbank payment systems
Attack Vector	Spear Phishing (job offer lures), trojanised software, social engineering of financial staff	Job offer LinkedIn lures specifically target finance professionals — widely reported tactic
Financial Operations	Bangladesh SWIFT ($81M), FASTCash ATM attacks, crypto exchange compromises ($3B+)	Demonstrates operational capability to execute large-scale financial transfers and exfiltration
Notable Operations	Sony Pictures (2014), WannaCry (2017), multiple crypto heists (2018-2024)	Cross-platform capability (Windows/Linux/macOS) covers all financial sector endpoint types



6.3 KIMSUKY — Velvet Chollima

KIMSUKY | Also known as: Velvet Chollima, Black Banshee, APT43, Thallium, TA406

Nation-State Attribution: Democratic People's Republic of Korea (DPRK) — Reconnaissance General Bureau

Motivation: Intelligence collection — economic and financial policy intelligence to support DPRK sanctions evasion strategy

Primary Sectors Targeted: Government, Think Tanks, Financial Policy Analysts, Insurance, Academics

Known Financial/Insurance Targeting: Targets financial policy researchers, SWIFT system analysts, FS-ISAC members; insurance sector for policy intelligence

Attribute	Detail	Financial Sector Implication
Known Tools	BabyShark, AppleSeed, PEBBLEDASH, Gold Dragon, Kimjongrat	BabyShark macro-based delivery is effective against financial staff who regularly process documents
Attack Vector	Highly targeted spear phishing — impersonates academics, journalists, and policy researchers	Insurance professionals receiving policy research emails are direct targets
Sector Focus	Financial regulators, central bank analysts, insurance sector policy staff	Insurance industry subject matter experts on sanctions, reinsurance, and financial policy are at risk
OPSEC	Long-dwell reconnaissance — KIMSUKY often maintains passive presence for months before acting	Financial sector dwell time before detection averages 197 days — KIMSUKY exploits this

6.4 SANDWORM — Voodoo Bear

SANDWORM | Also known as: Voodoo Bear, IRIDIUM, Seashell Blizzard, TeleBots, Olympic Destroyer

Nation-State Attribution: Russian Federation — GRU Unit 74455 (Main Centre for Special Technologies)

Motivation: Geopolitical disruption, economic sabotage, psychological operations in support of Russian foreign policy

Primary Sectors Targeted: Critical Infrastructure, Energy, Financial Services, Government, Media

Known Financial/Insurance Targeting: NotPetya (2017) caused $10B+ losses to financial sector; targeting of Ukrainian financial infrastructure; disruption of payment systems

Attribute	Detail	Financial Sector Implication
Known Tools	NotPetya, BlackEnergy, Industroyer, Olympic Destroyer, Cyclops Blink	NotPetya's financial sector impact ($10B+) demonstrates that geopolitical malware has collateral financial consequences
Attack Vector	Supply chain compromise, exploitation of network perimeter devices, watering holes	Financial sector's dependence on third-party software makes it vulnerable to SANDWORM supply chain TTPs
Financial Impact	NotPetya disrupted Maersk, DHL, and multiple financial institutions — not direct targets but collateral	Insurance sector absorbed billions in NotPetya claims — understanding SANDWORM TTPs is essential for underwriters
Escalation Risk	Conflict escalation in Europe triggers increased SANDWORM activity against Western financial institutions	Financial sector BCPs must account for geopolitical-trigger attack scenarios

6.5 FIN7 / Carbanak Group

FIN7 | Also known as: Carbanak, Carbon Spider, Sangria Tempest, ELBRUS, Navigator Group

Nation-State Attribution: Criminal Organisation — Russian-language, suspected Eastern European nexus

Motivation: Pure financial gain — bank robbery at scale using cyber techniques

Primary Sectors Targeted: Banking, Retail, Hospitality, Financial Services, Insurance (for PII monetisation)

Known Financial/Insurance Targeting: Carbanak campaign: $1.2B stolen from 100+ banks across 30 countries; targets insurance PII databases for identity fraud

Attribute	Detail	Financial Sector Implication
Known Tools	Carbanak malware, Cobalt Strike, Anunak, DICELOADER, PowerShell Empire	Cobalt Strike is the most commonly detected tool in financial sector incident response — FIN7 is primary deployer
Attack Vector	Spear Phishing with malicious Office documents; business email compromise; insider recruitment	BEC and financial wire transfer fraud are direct financial institution risks
Financial Operations	Carbanak: $1.2B from banks; ongoing retail POS malware campaigns; ransomware deployment	Insurance sector holds PII that FIN7 monetises through identity fraud — direct targeting risk
Adaptation	FIN7 evolved from bank targeting to ransomware as a service — demonstrates threat actor adaptability	Detection rules must account for both financial theft TTPs and ransomware deployment chain

6.6 TA505 / Clop Ransomware Group

TA505 | Also known as: Clop, EVIL CORP nexus, Hive0065, SectorJ04

Nation-State Attribution: Criminal Organisation — financially motivated ransomware-as-a-service operator

Motivation: Ransomware deployment and data extortion targeting high-revenue organisations

Primary Sectors Targeted: Banking, Financial Services, Insurance, Healthcare, Retail

Known Financial/Insurance Targeting: Clop ransomware has impacted multiple insurance companies; MOVEit Transfer exploitation (2023) exposed 1000+ organisations including financial institutions

Attribute	Detail	Financial Sector Implication
Known Tools	Clop ransomware, FlawedAmmyy, SdBot, Cobalt Strike, MOVEit exploitation	MOVEit exploitation (CVE-2023-34362) impacted financial sector file transfer infrastructure at massive scale
Attack Vector	Mass exploitation of file transfer software (MOVEit, GoAnywhere), phishing, malvertising	Financial sector's reliance on managed file transfer (MFT) solutions is a systemic vulnerability
Financial Impact	MOVEit campaign: 600+ organisations breached; multiple insurance and banking victims confirmed	TA505 specifically identifies high-value targets (insurance, banking) for maximum ransom leverage
Extortion Model	Double extortion: encrypt and threaten to publish sensitive financial/insurance data publicly	Insurance companies' regulatory data (policy details, claims) have high extortion value

6.7 Scattered Spider / UNC3944

Scattered Spider | Also known as: UNC3944, 0ktapus, Muddled Libra, Starfraud

Nation-State Attribution: Criminal Organisation — English-speaking, largely Western nexus (US/UK threat actors)

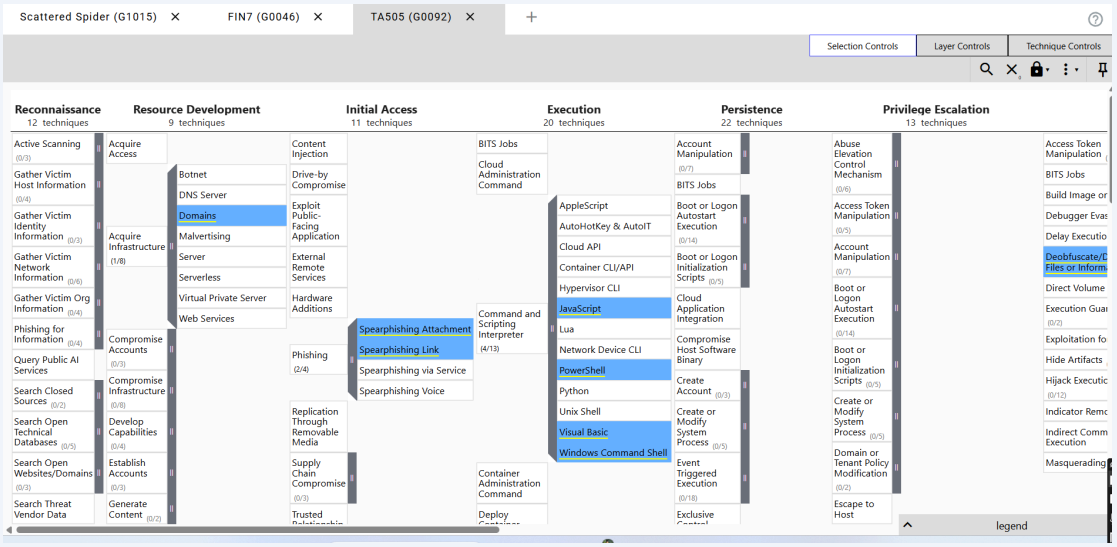
Motivation: Financial theft, data extortion, SIM swapping, cryptocurrency theft targeting insurance and financial sector

Primary Sectors Targeted: Insurance, Telecommunications, Financial Services, Retail, Gaming

Known Financial/Insurance Targeting: Confirmed attacks against insurance companies including MGM Resorts (cyber insurance implications); targets financial sector identity systems

Attribute	Detail	Financial Sector Implication
Known TTPs	Advanced social engineering, MFA bypass, SIM swapping, identity provider abuse, Okta exploitation	Insurance companies' identity and access management (IAM) systems are primary targets
Attack Vector	Voice phishing (vishing) of IT helpdesk staff; impersonation of employees; Okta/AAD exploitation	Financial sector helpdesk social engineering is a critical and underestimated attack vector

Insurance Focus	MGM Resorts attack exposed cyber insurance claims process; targets insurance identity databases	Insurance companies are both direct targets and participants in the financial ecosystem around breach response
Detection Challenge	English-speaking, culturally aware — evades common detection heuristics based on non-English OPSEC	Traditional detection approaches fail against native English-speaking social engineers



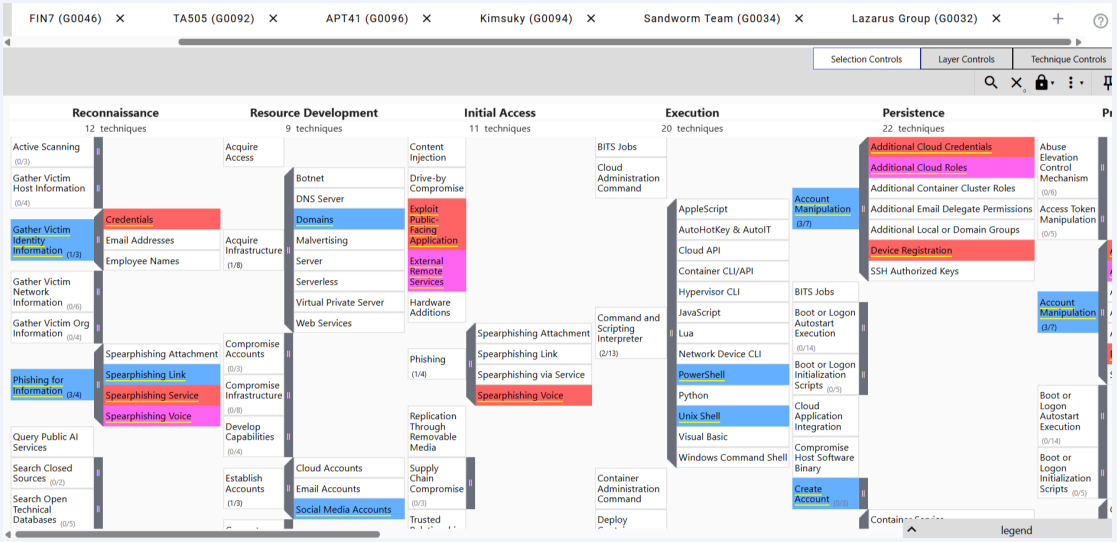
7. Phase 4 — MITRE ATT&CK Navigator: TTP Overlap Analysis

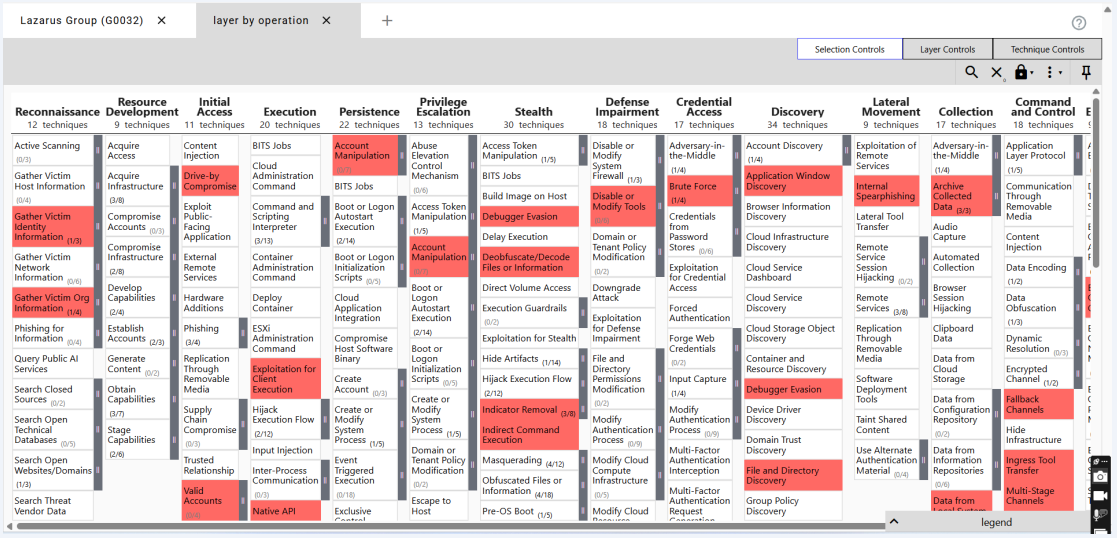
The MITRE ATT&CK Navigator was used to create individual technique layers for all seven APT groups, then generate a composite overlap layer. This is the analytical centrepiece of the threat intelligence engagement — it directly answers the question: 'Which detection controls will provide the broadest coverage against the greatest number of threats we face?'

7.1 Individual APT Layers

A separate ATT&CK Navigator layer was created for each of the seven APT groups. Each layer colour-codes the full set of MITRE ATT&CK techniques documented for that actor — providing a visual map of that actor's complete attack surface within the ATT&CK matrix.

Layer Name	APT Group	MITRE Group ID	Layer Colour / Notes
Layer 1 — APT41	APT41	G0096	Blue — dual-mandate espionage + financial TTPs
Layer 2 — LAZARUS	LAZARUS GROUP	G0032	Red — financial theft focus; extensive SWIFT targeting techniques
Layer 3 — KIMSUKY	KIMSUKY	G0094	Orange — intelligence collection; long-dwell techniques prominent
Layer 4 — SANDWORM	SANDWORM	G0034	Purple — destructive techniques; wiper and ICS techniques included
Layer 5 — FIN7	FIN7	G0046	Green — financial theft; POS malware and BEC techniques
Layer 6 — TA505	TA505	G0092	Dark red — ransomware chain; exfiltration and encryption techniques
Layer 7 — Scattered Spider	Scattered Spider	G1015	Teal — identity abuse; social engineering and IAM techniques





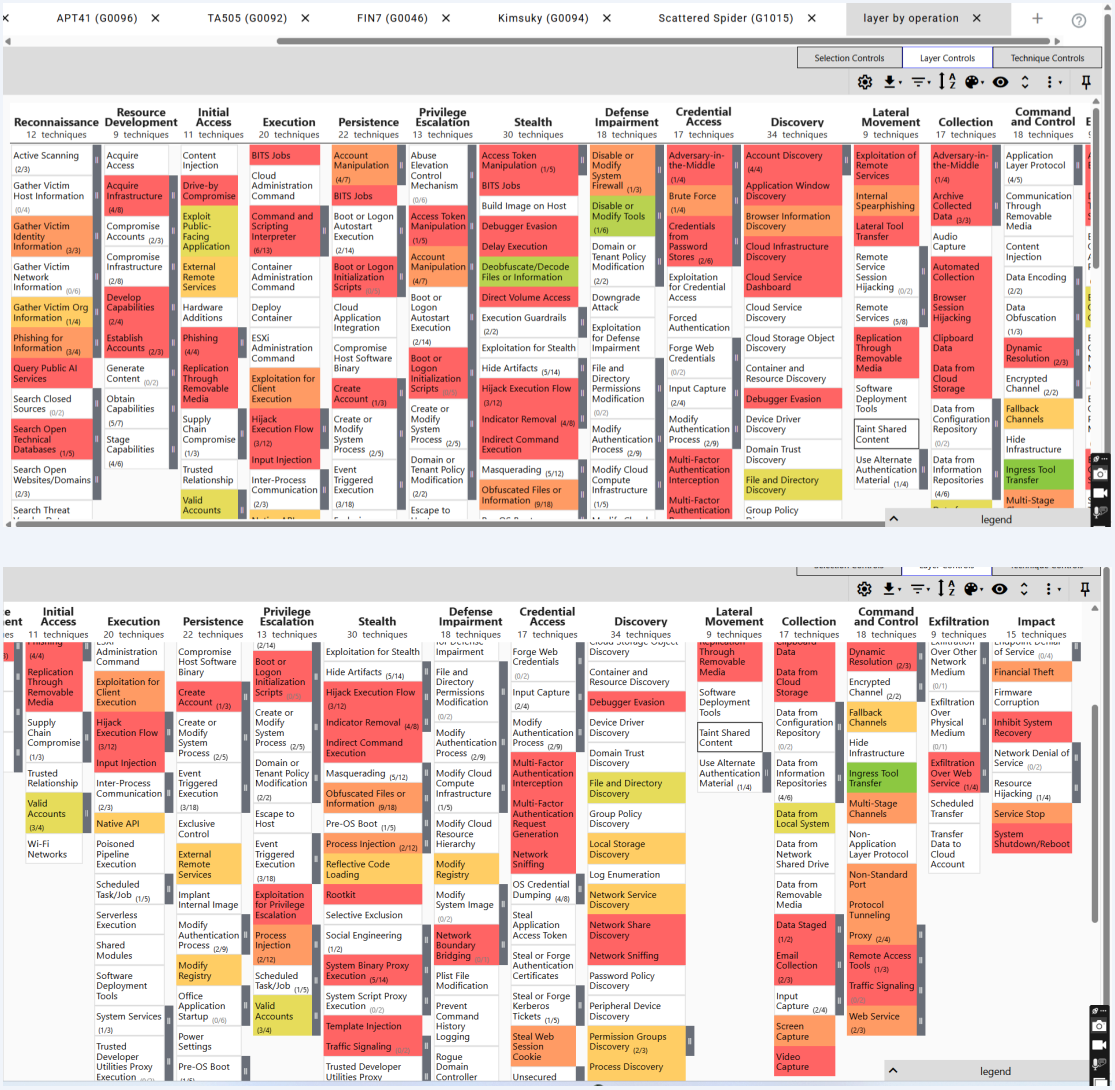
7.2 Composite Overlap Layer & Heatmap

The composite overlap layer was created by combining all seven individual APT layers and scoring each technique by the number of actors that employ it. The resulting heatmap colour-codes every technique by overlap score — darker colours indicate techniques used by more actors, and therefore represent higher-priority detection targets.

How to Read the Overlap Heatmap

Score 1 (light): Technique used by 1 actor — monitor
Score 2-3 (medium): Technique used by 2-3 actors — detect
Score 4-5 (dark): Technique used by 4-5 actors — alert
Score 6-7 (darkest / critical): Technique used by 6-7 actors — HIGHEST PRIORITY detection + automated response

Any technique scoring 5 or higher represents a control that, if detected, will fire against the majority of the identified threat landscape — making it the highest return-on-investment detection investment.



7.3 Highest-Priority Overlapping Techniques

The following ATT&CK techniques were identified as the highest-overlap across the seven profiled actors. These represent the detection priorities for the financial sector threat landscape.

T-ID	Technique	Tactic	Overlap Score	Actors Using
T1566	**Phishing**	Initial Access	**7/7 — ALL actors**	APT41, LAZARUS, KIMSUKY, SANDWORM, FIN7, TA505, Scattered Spider
T1078	**Valid Accounts**	Persistence / DA	**7/7 — ALL actors**	All actors leverage legitimate credentials post-compromise
T1059	**Command & Scripting Interpreter**	Execution	**7/7 — ALL actors**	PowerShell, cmd.exe, Python — universal execution technique
T1027	**Obfuscated Files or Information**	Defense Evasion	**5/7**	APT41, LAZARUS, KIMSUKY, FIN7, TA505, Scattered Spider
T1055	**Process Injection**	Defense Evasion	**6/7**	APT41, LAZARUS, SANDWORM, FIN7, TA505, KIMSUKY
T1003	**OS Credential Dumping**	Credential Access	**2/7**	APT41, LAZARUS,
T1486	**Data Encrypted for Impact**	Impact	**4/7**	SANDWORM, FIN7,, Scattered Spider, LAZARUS
T1041	**Exfiltration Over C2 Channel**	Exfiltration	**4/7**	APT41, LAZARUS, KIMSUKY, FIN7,
T1071	**Application Layer Protocol (C2)**	Command & Control	**6/7**	All actors use HTTP/HTTPS C2; LAZARUS and APT41 abuse cloud services
T1021	**Remote Services**	Lateral Movement	**6/7**	APT41, LAZARUS, SANDWORM, FIN7, TA505, Scattered Spider
T1136	**Create Account**	Persistence	**5/7**	Financial sector identity creation for persistent access
T1204	**User Execution**	Execution	**7/7 — ALL actors**	All actors rely on user interaction with malicious content for delivery

Tactic-Level Overlap Summary

Tactic	InitialAccess	Execution	Persistence	Defense Evasion	CredentialAccess	LateralMovement	Exfiltration	C2	Impact
Actor Count	7	7	3	5	4	2	4	6	4

8. Detection Capability Recommendations

The following detection recommendations are derived directly from the overlap analysis. Each recommendation targets a technique with a high overlap score — meaning the detection will fire against multiple actors in the identified threat landscape. Recommendations are prioritised by overlap score (highest first) and include the data sources required, detection logic guidance, and the actors it will detect against.

8.1 Priority 1 Detections — 7/7 Overlap (Fire Against ALL Actors)

ATT&CK ID	Technique	Data Source Required	Detection Logic	Covers Actors
T1566	**Phishing**	Email gateway logs, endpoint process execution logs	Alert on: email with weaponised attachment execution; macro execution from Office; link to newly registered domain	**All 7 actors**
T1078	**Valid Accounts**	Identity provider logs, AD login events (Event ID 4624/4625)	Alert on: login outside business hours; impossible travel; login from new device/location; sudden privilege use	**All 7 actors**
T1059	**Command Interpreter**	Windows Event Log (4688), EDR process telemetry	Alert on: PowerShell -EncodedCommand; cmd.exe spawned by Office process; WMIC executing remote processes	**All 7 actors**
T1204	**User Execution**	Email gateway, endpoint process telemetry, EDR	Alert on: Office macro execution; script execution from email attachment; user opening ISO/LNK from web download	**All 7 actors**

8.2 Priority 2 Detections — 6/7 Overlap

ATT&CK ID	Technique	Data Source Required	Detection Logic	Covers Actors
T1003	**Credential Dumping**	EDR, Sysmon Event 10 (LSASS access)	Alert on: LSASS memory access by non-system processes; secretsdump.py execution; Mimikatz signatures	**6/7 actors**
T1055	**Process Injection**	Sysmon Event 8 (CreateRemoteThread), EDR	Alert on: remote thread creation into lsass.exe, svchost.exe, explorer.exe; reflective DLL injection signatures	**6/7 actors**
T1027	**Obfuscation**	Process execution logs, email gateway, SIEM	Alert on: base64 encoded PowerShell commands; high entropy strings in	**6/7 actors**

			process arguments; VBA macro obfuscation	
T1071	**C2 over HTTP/HTTPS**	Network proxy logs, DNS query logs, NDR	Alert on: beaconing behaviour (regular interval outbound connections); C2 over CDN; DNS tunnelling patterns	**6/7 actors**
T1021	**Remote Services**	Windows Security Event 4624 (Type 3), firewall logs	Alert on: lateral RDP from non-admin workstations; SMB lateral movement; unexpected WinRM usage	**6/7 actors**

8.3 Financial Sector-Specific Detection Rules

- SWIFT/CHIPS Anomaly Detection: Alert on SWIFT message modification (T1565 — Data Manipulation); out-of-hours wire transfer authorisation; new payee accounts created by privileged users (LAZARUS GROUP primary TTP)
- Identity Provider Abuse: Alert on Okta/Azure AD conditional access bypass; new MFA method enrolled from unrecognised device; help desk password reset without prior user contact (Scattered Spider primary TTP)
- Ransomware Pre-Deployment Indicators: Alert on Volume Shadow Copy deletion (vssadmin delete shadows); inhibit system recovery commands; mass file encryption activity (TA505/Clop primary TTP)
- Reinsurance Data Exfiltration: Data Loss Prevention (DLP) alert on bulk export of actuarial or treaty data; anomalous access to reinsurance contract databases outside business hours (APT41 intelligence collection)

9. Proactive Threat Hunting Use Cases

The overlap analysis directly generates proactive threat hunting hypotheses — structured, testable questions that a threat hunter can investigate in SIEM, EDR, and network logs. Each use case below is derived from a high-overlap TTP and is scoped to the financial services threat landscape.

#	Hunt Hypothesis	Data Sources & Search Logic	Relevant Actor TTPs
H-1	**A threat actor has established a low-and-slow beaconing C2 channel from an internal financial system to external infrastructure using HTTPS (T1071.001)**	Query: proxy/firewall logs for outbound HTTPS connections at regular intervals (e.g. every 60s ±5s) to newly registered or low-reputation domains. Filter: exclude known-good CDNs. Time window: 30-day lookback.	APT41, LAZARUS, KIMSUKY, FIN7, TA505 — all use HTTPS-based C2
H-2	**An attacker has abused valid account credentials to authenticate to financial systems outside normal business hours and from a new geographic location (T1078 — Valid Accounts)**	Query: Identity provider logs (Azure AD, Okta) for login events between 23:00–06:00 local time OR from a country not previously associated with the user account. Correlate with HR system for business travel context.	Scattered Spider, FIN7, LAZARUS — credential abuse is universal across all actors
H-3	**A threat actor has performed credential dumping against LSASS to harvest domain credentials for lateral movement within the financial institution (T1003.001)**	Query: Sysmon Event ID 10 for access to lsass.exe by a non-SYSTEM process. Filter: exclude AV/EDR vendor processes. Correlate with subsequent login events (Event 4624) from the same host.	APT41, LAZARUS, SANDWORM, FIN7, TA505, KIMSUKY — 6/7 actors use this technique
H-4	**A ransomware pre-deployment actor has deleted volume shadow copies and disabled backup agents as a precursor to encryption (T1490 — Inhibit System Recovery)**	Query: Windows Event Log / EDR for execution of vssadmin.exe delete shadows, wbadmin.exe delete catalog, or bcdedit.exe /set recoveryenabled no. Alert immediately — these are terminal indicators preceding encryption.	TA505/Clop, SANDWORM — ransomware pre-encryption checklist

10. Strategic Intelligence Assessment

10.1 Threat Landscape Overview — Insurance & Financial Services

The insurance and financial services sector faces a uniquely complex threat landscape driven by three converging factors: the high financial value of direct theft operations (motivating criminal actors), the geopolitical and intelligence value of financial data (motivating nation-state actors), and the systemic importance of the sector to national economies (making it a target for disruptive operations). No other sector simultaneously faces the full spectrum of financially motivated, espionage-driven, and destructive threat actors at scale.

Strategic Finding	Assessment
SF-01: Convergence of actor types	Nation-state actors (LAZARUS, APT41) and criminal actors (FIN7, TA505) increasingly share tooling and techniques — nation-state-developed malware is adopted by criminal groups, and criminal infrastructure is leveraged by state actors. This blurs attribution and means financial sector defenders must assume both motivational types operate simultaneously.
SF-02: Insurance sector as both target and victim	The insurance sector faces a dual risk: as a direct target (for policyholder PII, underwriting data, and reinsurance intelligence) and as an indirect victim (insuring organisations attacked by the same threat actors). The rising frequency and severity of cyber claims is a direct consequence of the threat actors profiled in this report.
SF-03: Identity is the new perimeter	The highest-overlap technique across all seven actors is Valid Accounts (T1078) — adversaries universally prefer to log in rather than break in. The financial sector's reliance on cloud identity providers (Azure AD, Okta) creates a single point of failure that Scattered Spider has specifically weaponised.
SF-04: Geopolitical escalation = financial sector risk	SANDWORM's NotPetya demonstrated that geopolitical cyber conflict has direct financial sector consequences even when financial institutions are not the intended primary target. Escalation in any major geopolitical conflict (Russia-Ukraine, US-China, US-North Korea) should trigger elevated alert levels across the financial sector.
SF-05: SWIFT and payment infrastructure remain primary nation-state targets	LAZARUS GROUP has demonstrated sustained operational interest in SWIFT network access since 2016. No fundamental security improvement to the financial messaging ecosystem has eliminated this risk — it represents the single highest-consequence attack vector for the sector.

11. Key Findings

#	Finding	Detail & Implication
F-01	**7/7 overlap on Phishing (T1566) makes email security the single highest-ROI control**	Every identified threat actor uses phishing as a primary or secondary initial access vector. A mature email security programme — advanced anti-phishing, attachment sandboxing, DMARC enforcement, and user training — provides detection and prevention coverage against 100% of the profiled threat landscape.
F-02	**The TTP overlap analysis enables adversary-agnostic detection**	Organisations no longer need to build separate detection rules for each APT group. The 12 highest-overlap techniques, when fully detected, provide coverage across all seven profiled actors regardless of which specific adversary initiates an attack — dramatically improving detection efficiency.
F-03	**Scattered Spider represents an emerging and underestimated insurance sector threat**	Unlike traditional APTs that exploit technical vulnerabilities, Scattered Spider's social engineering and identity abuse techniques are specifically designed to bypass controls that financial institutions have invested heavily in. Insurance companies' IT helpdesk functions are a specific, documented attack target.
F-04	**SOCRadar.io + MITRE ATT&CK creates a repeatable, scalable threat intelligence workflow**	The combination of SOCRadar's threat actor database (for actor identification and prioritisation) with MITRE ATT&CK's technique framework (for TTP analysis) and the Navigator (for overlap visualisation) constitutes a complete, tool-supported threat intelligence workflow that can be repeated quarterly to maintain current intelligence.
F-05	**Strategic intelligence gaps exist in reinsurance and underwriting sector threat understanding**	While banking and retail financial services have mature threat intelligence communities (FS-ISAC), the reinsurance and specialist underwriting sub-sectors have limited sector-specific threat intelligence sharing. APT41 and KIMSUKY's interest in treaty and actuarial data represents an underappreciated threat vector for this sub-sector.

12. Screenshot Evidence Index

#	Screenshot Caption	Section	Tool / Source
1	SOCRadar.io — Threat Actor Search Results (Financial Services Filter)	5.1 — SOCRadar Search	SOCRadar.io Platform
2	SOCRadar.io — Individual APT Profile (e.g. LAZARUS GROUP)	5.2 — APT Shortlisting	SOCRadar.io Platform
3	MITRE ATT&CK — APT41 Technique Page (G0096)	6.1 — APT41 Profile	attack.mitre.org
4	MITRE ATT&CK — LAZARUS GROUP Technique Page (G0032)	6.2 — LAZARUS Profile	attack.mitre.org
5	MITRE ATT&CK — FIN7 / TA505 / Scattered Spider Group Pages	6.5–6.7 — eCrime Profiles	attack.mitre.org
6	ATT&CK Navigator — All 7 Individual Layers Listed (Layer Panel)	7.1 — Individual APT Layers	ATT&CK Navigator
7	ATT&CK Navigator — Individual Layer Example (LAZARUS GROUP Highlighted)	7.1 — Individual Layers	ATT&CK Navigator
8	ATT&CK Navigator — Composite Overlap Layer (All 7 APTs Combined)	7.2 — Overlap Layer	ATT&CK Navigator
9	ATT&CK Navigator — Overlap Heatmap Detail (Highest-Overlap Techniques)	7.3 — Highest Priority TTPs	ATT&CK Navigator

End of Threat Intelligence Report

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